and his Comrades' Collected Writings'). This is a welcome development. As much as sixty years after Independence. What Bhagat Singh is alleged to have said is still being contested. This is why K.C. Yadav has made a plea for scholars of Bhagat Singh 'to go to the original sources'.[7] Jagmohan Singh declared in an interview that 'it is our duty to liberate Bhagat Singh from current misinterpretations'. In a rebuke to emerging ethnonationalistic political movements, he added, 'Bhagat Singh cannot be frozen in a cheap emotional and nationalistic frame.'[8] The failure to do so risks misappropriation by right-wing ideologues, which will be the cause of 'Bhagat Singh's Second Hanging'.[9] So important is the task of remaining true to the real Bhagat Singh that in 2019, even some seventy years after Independence, in the memorable words of the noted western scholar, Dr Chris Moffat, 'To know what Bhagat Singh died for is to know why the living should also fight.'[10] He writes, 'If Bhagat Singh has been neglected – if he has been sidelined or sentimentalised – then to reconsider the revolutionary is a critical action, challenging the certainties otherwise attached to dominant Gandhian nationalist or socialist stories of postcolonial becoming.'[11] This indeed seems to be the reason for what Krishna Pratap Singh has described as 'the fate of the many revolutionaries whose memories have been cast into the abyss of oblivion'.[12]

In 1986, one of the three released Lahore conspirators, Shiv Verma, published a collection of Bhagat Singh's writings where he castigated the attempt 'to distort the ideological side of the revolutionary movement' by portraying them as 'blood-thirsty demons' and with 'no aim, no set purpose in life' because, as he explained, '[t]hat Bhagat Singh was an intellectual of high calibre is not known to many'. This is why he had now 'strived to put all available writings of Bhagat Singh at one place and to leave it to the reader to form his own opinion . . .'.[13] In the same way, P.C. Joshi, a leading light of the Indian communist movement, referred during the rise of the Naxalite rebellion in 1969 to what distinguished Bhagat Singh as, 'his undying thirst for knowledge', while still recognizing him as 'the emblem of death-defying determination'.[14] Chaman Lal writes of him that while he was 'fond of films, especially Charlie Chaplin films' and was even